



Problem Framing

Spotify is designed primarily for entertainment and discovery, targeting young users and working professionals; however, A significant segment – students preparing for competitive exams like JEE, NEET, and UPSC – use it with the intent of improving focus and productivity while studying, a need that the current experience does not adequately support.

Target User Segment – Competitive Exam Students



Characteristics

- Study for long hours
- Require deep focus environments
- Are easily distracted by digital platforms

User Persona



Rohit Sharma

19 Y/O School student preparing for JEE

Goals

- Maintain long, uninterrupted study sessions
- Use music as a tool for focus

Pain points

- Distracted by recommendations and notifications
- Has to manually search for suitable music
- No way to track productivity
- Music apps are not built for “study intent”

Existing User journey Mapping

	Entry (App Open)	Content Discovery	Session Start	During Session	Session Completion	Long-Term Engagement
User Actions	Opens app to study	Searches "lofi"/focus music	Selects playlist & starts	Studies while listening	Stops music	Repeats usage daily
User Thoughts	I need to focus quickly	Which one is best?	Hope this works	Let me check this...	Was I productive?	This isn't helping much
Pain Points	Cluttered homepage; No study entry	Too many options; Decision fatigue; Irrelevant suggestions	No structure; No goals	Notifications; Distraction loops	No tracking; No motivation	No habit building; No personalization
Opportunities	Focus Mode entry; Intent-based UI	Curated playlists; Categorization	Guided sessions; Goal setting	Distraction-free mode; Minimal UI	Dashboard; Streaks	Habit system; Smart recommendations

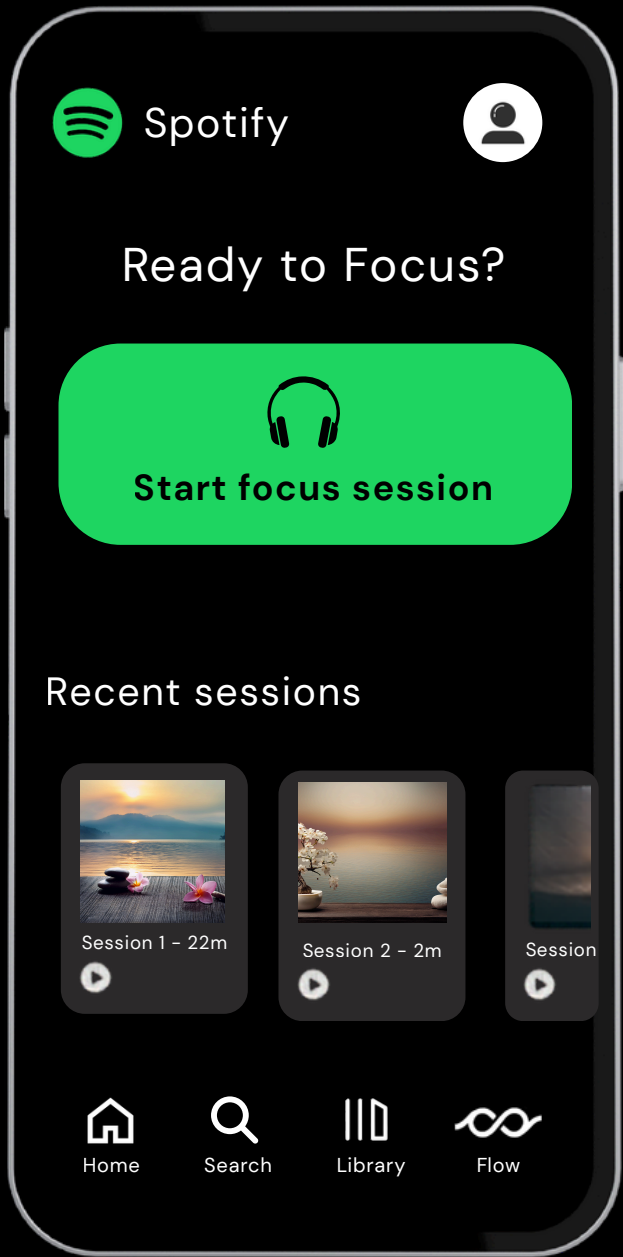


Solution – Flow Mode

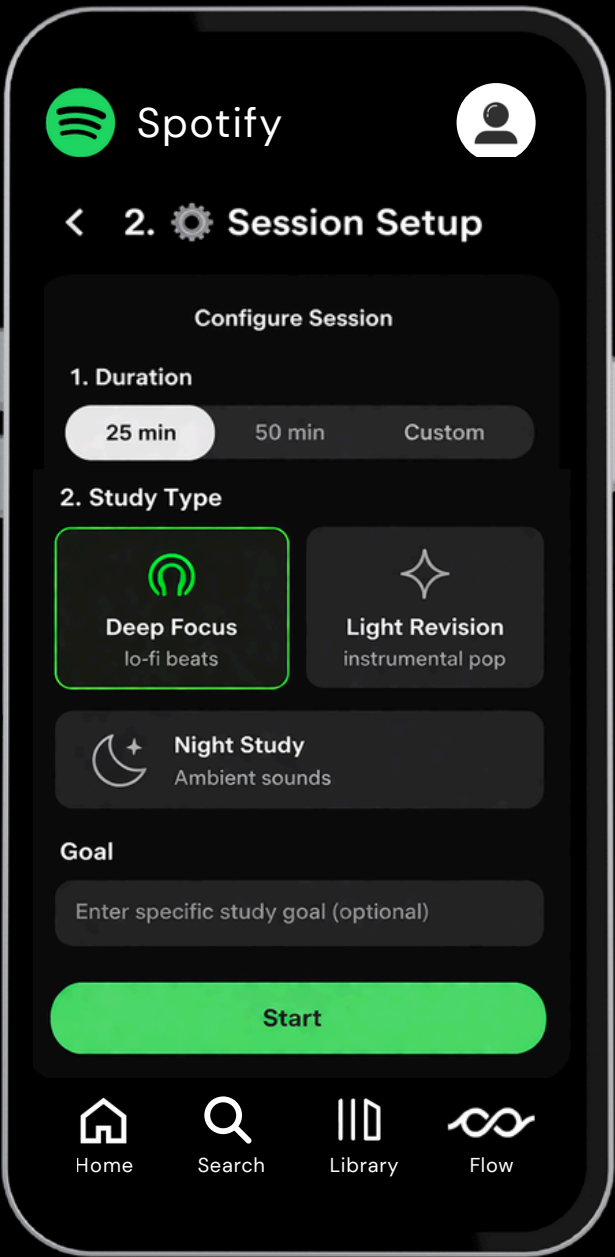
Spotify Flow

Spotify Flow is a dedicated, distraction-free experience within Spotify that transforms it from an exploration-based music platform into a goal-oriented study companion by enabling students to instantly start structured sessions, access curated focus audio, stay free from interruptions, and track their productivity over time.

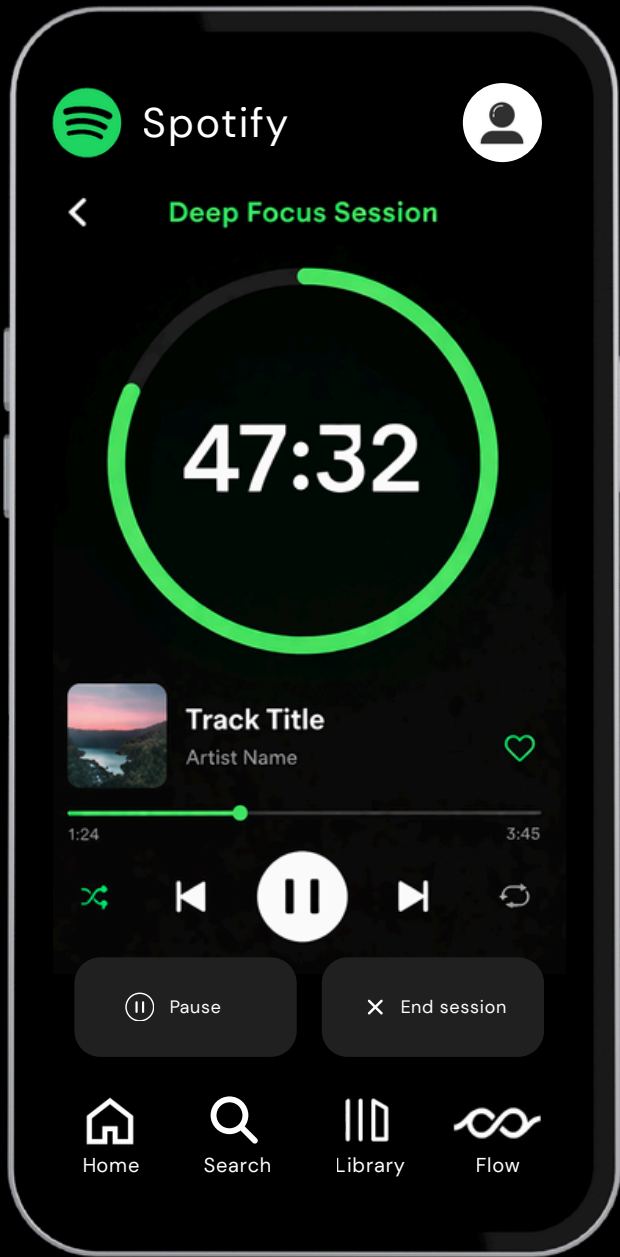
Wire Frames



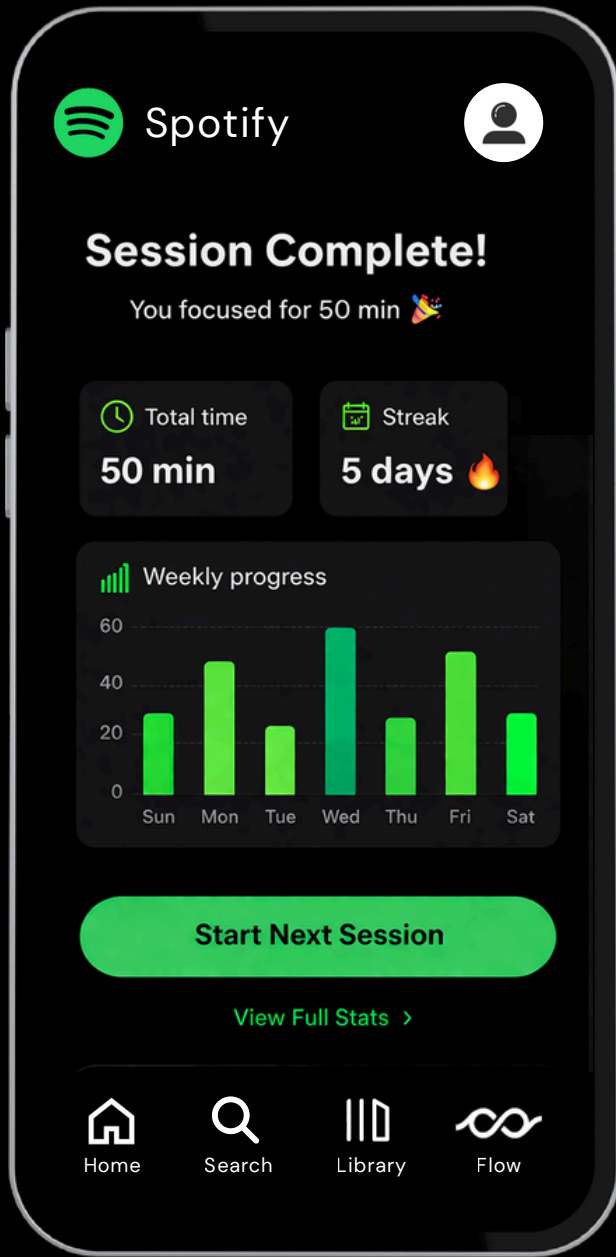
1. Flow Mode
Entry Screen



2. Session
Setup screen



3. Active focus
Session screen



4. Focus summary
Dashboard

Core Features

- **One-Tap Focus Entry:** Instant access from homepage
- **Curated Study Hub:** Pre-filtered focus playlists
- **Guided Sessions:** Time-bound (Pomodoro-based) sessions
- **Distraction-Free Mode:** Blocks interruptions and UI clutter
- **Focus Summary:** Tracks time, streaks, and progress

Design Rationale

Each design decision directly addresses key pain points identified in the user journey

- A **one-tap entry point** reduces friction and enables users to start sessions instantly without navigating a cluttered interface.
- The **curated study hub** minimizes decision fatigue by limiting choices to focus-optimized audio.
- **Guided sessions** introduce structure through time-bound workflows, helping users maintain consistent study routines.
- A **distraction-free interface** eliminates interruptions and cognitive overload, enabling deep work.
- The **focus summary** dashboard provides feedback and reinforcement, encouraging habit formation through progress tracking and streaks.